

Designing a Paperless *Expense Tracker* for Employees & Finance Teams

ExpenseSnap is an internal mobile application designed to replace manual, paper-based expense tracking. As Product Designer, I led the full experience from discovery to prototype — including UX research, journey mapping, style guide, wireframes, and user testing.

PROJECT	ROLE
ExpenseSnap	Product Designer
TYPE	USERS
Internal Initiative	Employees & Finance

- Mobile App Design
- UX Research
- AI-Assisted PRD
- Fintech
- OCR
- Product Thinking

Paperless Eliminated manual paper receipt tracking	OCR-powered Auto-extract expense details from receipts	SSO-secured Safe access via Company SSO login
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THE PROBLEM

Paper-based tracking was slowing *everyone* down

Before ExpenseSnap, employees tracked expenses manually — through physical receipts, spreadsheets, or ad hoc notes. This created friction on both sides, with no real-time visibility and no consistent process.

01 Lost receipts Paper receipts were frequently misplaced before reimbursement could be processed.	02 Slow reimbursements Manual data entry and validation caused significant delays in the finance review process.
03 No spending visibility No central view of employee spending by category, date, or payment method.	04 No standard process Different employees submitted expenses differently, creating inconsistent data.

MY ROLE

End-to-end product design with *AI-assisted* documentation

I was involved from the very start — not just as the designer, but as a contributor to the product definition process. This included drafting and reviewing the BRD, generating the PRD using Claude AI and validating it with the team, before moving into the full design lifecycle.

AI-ASSISTED WORKFLOW	AI-Assisted PRD via Claude Used Claude AI to generate the initial PRD from the reviewed BRD — a first for the team that significantly reduced documentation time while maintaining quality through team validation.
BRD	BRD Drafting & Review Collaborated in writing and reviewing the Business Requirements Document to align stakeholders before design began.
FULL DESIGN	End-to-End Design Execution Led user research, journey mapping, style guide, wireframes, mockups, prototype, and user testing — end to end.

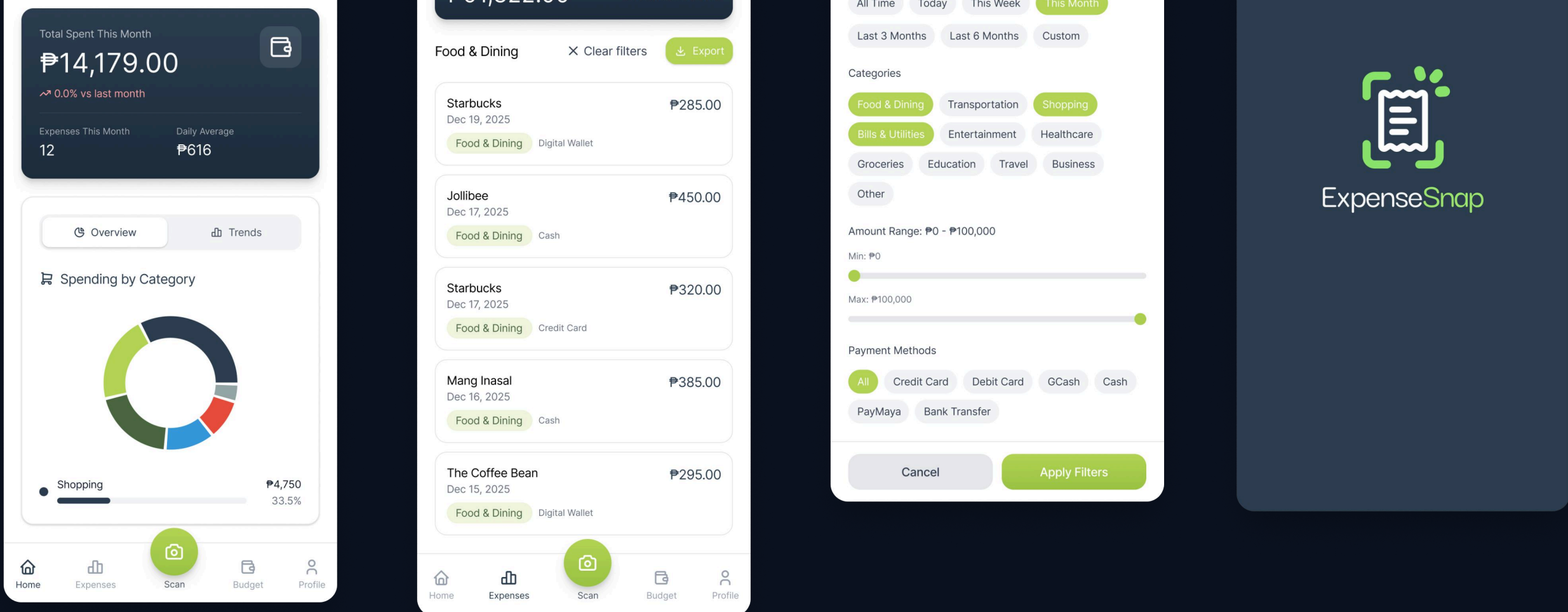
THE PROCESS

Discovery-driven, *iterative* design

01 Discovery	User Research & Interviews Interviewed employees and finance team members to understand expense tracking habits, frustrations, and needs. Key insight: employees wanted something as fast as taking a photo; finance wanted clean, exportable data.
02 AI-SDLC	BRD Drafting & AI-Powered PRD Co-authored the BRD with stakeholders, capturing business goals and functional requirements. Used Claude AI to generate the initial PRD, which was then reviewed, challenged, and validated with product and engineering teams.
03 Define	Journey Mapping & Style Guide Mapped user journeys for both employee and finance team personas. Established the visual style guide: dark navy + green palette, card-based layout, and accessible typography.
04 Design	Wireframes & Mockups Progressed from low-fidelity wireframes to high-fidelity mockups across all key screens: splash, dashboard, expenses list, filter, scan/OCR, budget, and profile.
05 Validate	User Testing & Iteration Conducted user testing sessions with employees across departments to validate usability and refine interactions — particularly around the filter system and the OCR scan experience.

SCREEN DESIGNS

Key screens from the *final prototype*



KEY CHALLENGE

Designing for a *moving target*

The biggest challenge on ExpenseSnap was that requirements weren't fully defined at the start — and intentionally so. As the team built and tested, new relevant features emerged that weren't in the original scope.

Rather than treating this as a problem, I leaned into it as a feature of the discovery process. I designed screens to be modular and easy to update, kept close communication with engineering to avoid costly rework, and used back-and-forth requirement changes as signals to revisit user needs.

"What we added was genuinely useful, not just a feature for its own sake."

DESIGN HIGHLIGHTS

Key UX decisions worth *calling out*

NAVIGATION	01	INTERACTION	02
Scan as the primary CTA The camera/scan button was placed as a prominent floating action in the center of the nav bar — making receipt capture the fastest and most natural action in the app.		Multi-dimensional filter system The filter UI supports simultaneous filtering by date range, category, amount range, and payment method — giving power users full control without overwhelming casual users.	
INFORMATION ARCHITECTURE	03	MICROINTERACTIONS	04
Dashboard for quick comprehension The home dashboard prioritizes total spend, category breakdown via donut chart, top spends, and recent transactions — so users understand their financial picture in seconds.		Feedback-first interaction design Success states like the "Expense saved" toast notification give users immediate confidence that their action worked — reducing anxiety around data loss.	

THE OUTCOME

A cleaner, faster, *paperless* expense workflow

100% Paper-free Successfully replaced the manual, paper-based expense process with a fully digital, mobile-first workflow accessible to all employees.	Real-time Finance visibility Finance teams gained real-time visibility into employee spending through categorized dashboards and exportable expense reports.	AI-SDLC Adopted as practice The AI-assisted PRD process was adopted as a repeatable practice for future projects across the team.
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LESSONS LEARNED

What I'd carry into the *next project*

01	Iterative discovery is a feature, not a flaw.	Letting requirements evolve through building and testing led to a more relevant product — features users actually asked for, not features assumed upfront.
02	AI speeds up documentation; human judgment validates it.	Using Claude to generate the PRD saved significant time — but the real value came from the team validation session that caught gaps and refined assumptions.
03	Modular design pays off in agile environments.	Designing components to be reusable and independent made it much easier to absorb mid-sprint requirement changes without starting from scratch.